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Make failure cheap and loud.



4 guardrails that cut wasted **Databricks spend** on failed jobs. All configuration. No migration.

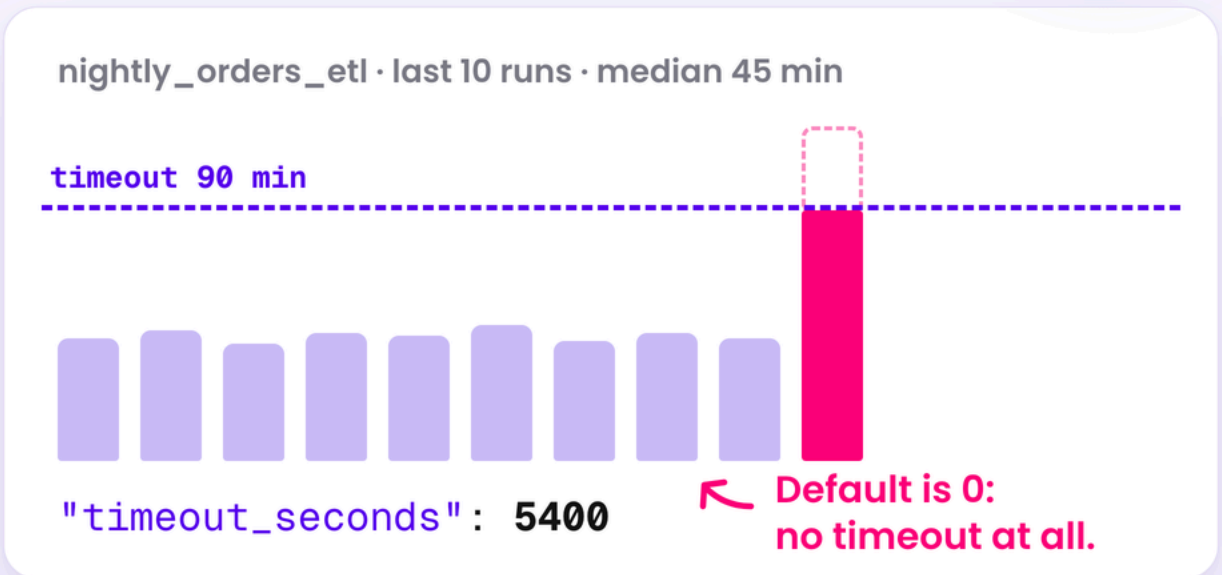
- Timeouts
- Retries
- Pre-checks
- Cost alerts

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1 Timeouts set from real runtime

Set it from each job's own history, for example **2x the median.** A 45-minute job then stops at 90, not at sunrise.





No timeout means no stop.

Default per the Databricks Jobs API docs. Run times are illustrative.

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2 Retries with a ceiling and an interval

Retries help with flaky sources. With bad code they just **repeat the bill.** Cap them, space them out, and agree when a failure needs a human.



```
"max_retries": 2,
```

↖ Default is 0. Set -1 and it retries forever.

```
"min_retry_interval_millis": 600000
```

↖ Leave it out and retries fire at once.

Two retries, ten minutes apart. Then a human.

Defaults per the Databricks Jobs API docs.

3 A cheap check before the expensive work



Is the input there? Is it the right shape? Is it non-empty? **Failing at minute one costs pennies.** Failing at minute fifty costs the whole run.

Job: nightly_orders_etl

validate_input
~1 min

transform_orders
~50 min, big cluster

publish
~3 min

Fail here: pennies

Fail here: the whole run

Put the gate at the front.

Run times are illustrative.

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4 Alerts that include the cost and the owner



Put the failed-run cost and a named owner in the alert. Failure stops being invisible to the people who **pay for it.**

`nightly_orders_etl` failed — Acknowledged

`nightly_orders_etl` failed after 2 retries and burned **$312** of compute.
Owner: Data Platform team — Fixed

"Failed" gets acknowledged. "Burned $312" gets fixed.

$312 is an illustrative figure.

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With **Srinath Reddy**,
founder and CEO of BigHammer.ai



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